



GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU

HIGHER SECONDARY - SECOND YEAR

ENGLISH

A publication under Free Textbook Programme of Government of Tamil Nadu

Department of School Education

Untouchability is Inhuman and a Crime

Government of Tamil Nadu

First Edition - 2019
Revised Edition - 2020, 2022
Reprint - 2021, 2023, 2024

(Published under New Syllabus)

NOT FOR SALE

Content Creation



State Council of Educational
Research and Training

© SCERT 2019

Printing & Publishing



Tamil NaduTextbook and Educational
Services Corporation

www.textbooksonline.tn.nic.in

PREFACE

The general English syllabus for Class 12 aligns with the recommendations of the National Curriculum Framework 2005. Based on the communicative approach to language learning, the textbook follows the design and structure of the revised class 11 Course Book published in 2017. The 21st Century learner needs to be able to competently collaborate, think critically, solve problems and access digital resources proficiently. Therefore, the selected texts, drawn from different genres, themes and writings across the world are age appropriate, value oriented and motivating. The tasks based on the texts encourage and train the learner to:

- ❖ seamlessly integrate the use of the four major language skills, namely listening, speaking, reading and writing naturally and confidently
- ❖ acquire fluency and accuracy in Speaking and Writing and ensure appropriate use of format, style and structure
- ❖ enrich vocabulary through guided practice
- ❖ develop an attitude of contemplation and enquiry which fosters analytical and critical thinking skills
- ❖ understand and appreciate prose, poetry and drama
- ❖ inculcate creativity and initiative
- ❖ understand contemporary issues that they will face in the world outside the school
- ❖ participate actively in the learning process by following clear guidelines that encourage collaborative learning through pair work, group work and whole class work

Special Features

- ❖ Warm-up activities lead the students to the theme of each lesson.
- ❖ Warm up activities lead the students to the theme of each text.
- ❖ Includes texts from a wide variety of genres offering learning experiences which promote discussion, and writing with clarity and creativity, facilitate the learners to analyze, interpret and extrapolate the texts.
- ❖ 'Item boxes' are given wherever suitable, to encourage learners to read beyond the prescribed texts.
- ❖ Language skills are reinforced by relevant 'check-points', intensive practice in speaking, listening, reading and writing.
- ❖ Vocabulary is expanded and grammar is internalised.
- ❖ Interesting activities are provided to motivate learners to use the language in context and acquire essential language skills.
- ❖ Innovative features like Grammar Games, ICT Corner, Infographics and Learning Links lead the learners to further learning.



An Overview

Unit - 1

The prose section contains a touching narration titled **'Two Gentlemen of Verona'** by **A.J. Cronin**, which describes the responsible and mature behaviour of two young brothers who toil day and night to pay for the treatment of their elder sister, a war victim who suffers from a critical disease. **'The Castle'** by **Edwin Muir** describes the fall of a formidable castle caused by betrayal from within. The supplementary section consists of **Leo Tolstoy's** short story **'God Sees the Truth but Waits'**, which describes the ultimate triumph of truth proving a convict's innocence. It also brings out the magnanimous nature of Aksionov who forgives the actual culprit and breathes his last peacefully.

Grammar : Tenses, Modal auxiliaries, Reported speech

Writing : Letter Writing

Unit - 2

A Nice Cup of Tea is an essay by **George Orwell**. It is a description of the craft of making tea. In the poem **'Our Casuarina Tree'** the poet **Toru Dutt** describes the huge tree in her garden which symbolises her happy childhood associations. **'Life of Pi'** by **Yann Martel** is a 'fantasy' which describes the incredible experience of a young man who survives a dangerous ordeal in the sea. The story was made into a film in the year 2012.

Grammar : Prepositions, Prepositional phrases, Conjunctions and connectives.

Writing : Article Writing, Essay Writing

Unit - 3

'In Celebration of Being Alive' is an extract from a speech of **Dr. Christian Barnard**, the first doctor to perform a heart transplant surgery. The doctor recounts an incident involving two critically ill children, whose zest for life made him understand how important it is to celebrate being alive. **William Shakespeare's** poem **'All the World's a Stage'**, traces the seven different stages in a man's life with all the characteristics of each stage. **Percival Wilde's** play **'The Hour of Truth'** forms the supplementary section, portraying the integrity of Robert Baldwin and his painful sacrifice of friendship in defence of truth.

Grammar : Active & Passive Voice, Interrogations or Questions

Writing : Story Writing

Unit - 4

'The Summit' is a travelogue – an amazing account of the conquest of Mt. Everest by **Edmund Hillary** and Tenzing Norgay. The poem **'Ulysses'** by **Alfred Tennyson** describes the mythical Greek hero's unquenchable thirst for adventure. **'The Midnight Visitor'** by **Robert Arthur**, is a gripping story of high drama at midnight in which a detective who defies stereotype outwits a hardened criminal with his quick wit and presence of mind.

Grammar : Kinds of Sentences, Conditional Clauses

Writing : Summarizing, Interpreting Non-Verbal Presentations

Unit - 5

'The Chair' is a short story by **Ki. Rajanarayanan** which narrates the humorous incidents that happen after the arrival of a chair. The poem **'A Father to his Son'** by **Carl August Sandburg** captures a loving father's invaluable advice to his son. **'All Summer in a Day'** by **Ray Bradbury**, a piece of science fiction, explores the theme of life on planet Venus.

Grammar : Non-Finite Verbs, Degrees of Comparison

Writing : Slogan Writing, Paragraph Writing

Unit - 6

'On the Rule of the Road' an essay by **A.G Gardiner**, emphasises the importance of responsible public behaviour respecting the liberty of others and upholding the norms of the society. The poem **'Incident of the French Camp'** by **Robert Browning**, is a heartrending story of a young soldier who sacrifices his life for the sake of his country with great pride and honour. The humorous play **'Remember Caesar'** by **Gordon Daviot** revolves around Lord Weston's mistaken threat to his life.

Grammar : Concord

Writing : Describing a Process

Contents

1	Prose	Two Gentlemen of Verona	1	June
	Poem	The Castle	19	
	Supplementary	God Sees the Truth but Waits	24	
2	Prose	A Nice Cup of Tea	34	July
	Poem	Our Casuarina Tree	52	
	Supplementary	Life of Pi	58	
3	Prose	In Celebration of Being Alive	67	August
	Poem	All the World's a Stage	88	
	Supplementary	The Hour of Truth (Play)	95	
4	Prose	The Summit	111	August
	Poem	Ulysses	127	&
	Supplementary	The Midnight Visitor	135	September
5	Prose	The Chair	142	October
	Poem	A Father to his Son	162	
	Supplementary	All Summer in a Day	169	
6	Prose	On the Rule of the Road	178	November
	Poem	Incident of the French Camp	190	&
	Supplementary	Remember Caesar (Play)	196	December



E - book



Assessment

Unit

1

Prose

Two Gentlemen of Verona
A J Cronin

Warm Up

Life is full of ups and downs. It has pleasant surprises as well as rude shocks. Nevertheless, every incident offers a lesson for us to learn and evolve into better individuals.

Mention some unexpected challenges or adversities one could face in life.

What qualities do you think one should possess to handle hardships and overcome them?

Here is a story about love, devotion, sacrifice, sincerity and maturity displayed by two little boys in their actions to save the life of their sister who suffers from tuberculosis of the spine. Read the story to find out how their actions give a new hope for humanity.

As we drove through the foothills of the Alps two small boys stopped us on the outskirts of Verona. They were selling wild strawberries. “Don’t buy,” warned Luigi, our cautious driver. “You will get much better fruit in Verona. Besides, these boys.....”

He **shrugged** his shoulders to convey his disapproval of their shabby appearance.

One boy had on a worn jersey and cut-off khaki pants; the other a shortened army **tunic** gathered in loose folds about his skinny frame. Yet, gazing at the two little figures, with their brown skins, tangled hair and dark earnest eyes, we felt ourselves strangely attracted. My companion spoke to the boys, discovered that they were brothers. Nicola, the elder, was 13; Jacopo, who barely came up to the door handle of the car, was nearly 12. We bought their biggest basket, and then set off toward town.

Next morning, coming out of our hotel, we saw our friends bent over shoe shine boxes beside the fountain in the public square, doing brisk business.



We watched for a few moments; then as trade **slackened** we went over. They greeted us with friendly faces.

"I thought you picked fruit for a living," I said. "We do many things, sir," Nicola answered seriously. He glanced at us hopefully. "Often we show visitors through the town ... to Juliet's tomb ... and other places of interest."

"All right," I smiled. "You take us along."

As we made the rounds, my interest was again provoked by their remarkable **demeanour**. They were childish enough, and in many ways quite **artless**. Jacopo was lively as a squirrel. Nicola's smile was steady and engaging. Yet in both these boyish faces there was a seriousness which was far beyond their years. In the week which followed we saw them frequently, for they proved extremely useful to us. If we wanted a pack of American cigarettes, or seats for the opera or the name of good restaurant, Nicola and Jacopo could be

relied upon to satisfy our needs. What struck one most was their willingness to work. During these summer days, under the hot sun, they shined shoes, sold fruit, **hawked** newspapers, conducted tourists round the town, and ran errands.

One night, we came upon them in the windy and **deserted** square, resting on the stone pavement beneath the lights. Nicola sat upright, tired. A bundle of unsold newspapers lay at his feet. Jacopo, his head resting upon his brother's shoulder was asleep. It was nearly midnight.

"Why are you out so late, Nicola?"

"Waiting for the last bus from Padua. We shall sell all our papers when it comes in."

"Must you work so hard? You both look rather tired."

"We are not complaining, sir."

But next morning, when I went over to the fountain to have my shoes shined, I said, "Nicola, the way you and Jacopo work, you must earn quite a bit. You spend nothing on clothes. You eat little enough --- when I see you have a meal it's usually black bread and figs. Tell me, what do you do with your money?"

He coloured deeply under his sunburn and then grew pale. He looked to the ground.

"You must be saving up to **emigrate** to America," I suggested. He looked at me sideways, spoke with an effort.

"We should greatly like to go to the States. But here, at present, we have other plans."

“What plans?”

He smiled uncomfortably. “Just plans, sir,” he answered in a low voice.

“Well,” I said, “we’re leaving on Monday. Is there anything I can do for you before we go?” Nicola shook his head, but suddenly Jacopo said, “Sir,” he burst out, “every Sunday we make a visit to the country, to Poleta, 30 kilometres from here. Usually we hire bicycles. But tomorrow, since you are so kind, you might send us in your car.”

I had already told Luigi he might have the Sunday off. However, I answered, “I’ll drive you out myself.”

There was a pause. Nicola was glaring at his young brother in **vexation**. “We could not think of troubling you, sir.”

“It won’t be any trouble.”

He bit his lip, then, in a rather put out tone, he said, “Very well.”

The following afternoon we drove to the tiny village set high upon the hillside. I imagined that our destinations would be some humble dwellings. But, directed by Jacopo, we drew up at a large red-roofed villa, surrounded by a high stone wall. I could scarcely believe my eyes and before I could recover breath my two passengers had leaped from the car.

“We shall not be long, sir. Perhaps only an hour. May be you’d like to go to the cafe in the village for a drink?” They disappeared beyond the corner of the wall.

After a few minutes I followed. I found a grilled side-entrance and, determinedly, rang the bell.

A pleasant-looking woman with steel-rimmed spectacles appeared. I blinked as I saw that she was dressed in the white uniform of a trained nurse.

“I just brought two small boys here.”

“Ah, yes.” Her face lit up; she opened the door to admit me. “Nicola and Jacopo. I will take you up.”

She led me through a cool, tiled **vestibule** into the hospital – for hospital the villa had become. At the door of a little cubicle the nurse paused, put her finger to her lips, and with a smile bade me look through the glass partition. The two boys were seated at the bedside of a girl of about twenty who, propped up on pillows, wearing a pretty lace jacket, was listening to their **chatter**, her eyes soft and tender. One could see at a glance her resemblance to her brothers. A vase of wild flowers stood on her table, beside a dish of fruit and several books.

“Won’t you go in?” the nurse murmured. “Lucia will be pleased to see you.”

I shook my head and turned away. I felt I could not bear to **intrude** upon this happy family party. But at the foot of the staircase I drew up and begged her to tell me all she knew about these boys.

She was eager to do so. “They were”, she explained, “quite alone in the world, except for this sister, Lucia. Their father, a widower, a well-known singer, had been killed in the early part of the war. Shortly afterward a bomb had destroyed their home and thrown the three children into the streets. They had always known a comfortable and cultured life – Lucia had

herself been training as a singer– and they had suffered horribly from near starvation and exposure to the cold winter”.

For months they had barely kept themselves alive in a sort of shelter they built with their own hands amidst the **rubble**. Then for three years the Germans ruled the city. The boys grew to hate the Germans. When the resistance movement began secretly to form they were among the first to join. When the war was over, and we had peace at last, they came back to their beloved sister. And they found her –suffering from tuberculosis of the spine.”



She paused, took a quick breath. “Did they give up? I do not have to answer that question. They brought her here, persuaded us to take her into the hospital. In the twelve months she has been our patient she has made good progress. There is every hope that one day she will walk– and sing–again.”

“Of course, everything is so difficult now, food so scarce and dear, we could not keep going unless we charged a fee. But every week, Lucia’s brothers have made their payment.” She added simply, “I don’t know what they do, I do not ask. Work is scarce in Verona. But whatever it is, I know they do it well.”

“Yes,” I agreed. “They couldn’t do it better.”

I waited outside until the boys rejoined me, and then drove them back to the city. They sat beside me, not speaking. For my part, I did not say a word–I knew they would prefer to feel that they had safely kept their secret. Yet their devotion had touched me deeply.

War had not broken their spirit. Their selfless action brought a new nobility to human life, gave promise of a greater hope for human society.

About The Author

Archibald Joseph Cronin (1896–1981) was a Scottish novelist, dramatist and physician. A doctor by training, Cronin was one of the most renowned storytellers of the twentieth century. Many of his stories have emerged from his medical career and are noted for their narrative skill, deep social conscience and finely drawn characters. Cronin’s books were not only bestsellers but some of them (such as **The Citadel** and **The Keys of the Kingdom**) were made into successful films and were adapted for radio and television. His novella **Country Doctor** was adapted for a long running BBC radio and TV series.





Glossary

shrug	- raise one's shoulders slightly and momentarily
tunic	- a loose outer garment without sleeves
slackened	- reduced
demeanour	- appearance and behaviour
artless	- innocent, guileless
hawk	- sell things crying out loudly, going from place to place
deserted	- uninhabited, unoccupied
emigrate	- take up citizenship of another country
vexation	- annoyance
vestibule	- lobby
chatter	- a series of short, quick high-pitched sounds
intrude	- enter without permission
rubble	- debris, broken bricks

1. Answer the following questions in one or two sentences each based on your understanding of the story.

- Who did the narrator meet at the outskirts of Verona?
- Why did the driver not approve of the narrator buying fruits from the boys?
- The boys did not spend much on clothes and food. Why?
- Were the boys saving money to go to the States? How do you know?
- Why did the author avoid going to Lucia's room?
- What was Lucia suffering from?
- What made the boys join the resistance movement against the Germans?

h) What made the boys work so hard?

i) Why didn't the boys disclose their problem to the author?

2. Answer the following questions in three or four sentences each.

- Describe the appearance of Nicola and Jacopo.
- What were the various jobs undertaken by the little boys?
- How did the narrator help the boys on Sunday?
- Who took the author to the cubicle?
- Describe the girl with whom the boys were talking to in the cubicle.
- Recount the untold sufferings undergone by the siblings after they were rendered homeless.
- The narrator did not utter a word and preferred to keep the secret to himself. Why? Substantiate the statement with reference to the story.

3. Answer the following in a paragraph of 100–150 words each.

- What was the driving force that made the boys do various jobs?
- How was the family affected by the war?
- Write a character sketch of Nicola and Jacopo.
- What message is conveyed through the story 'Two Gentlemen of Verona'?
- Justify the title of the story 'Two Gentlemen of Verona'.
- Adversity brings out the best as well as the worst in people. Elucidate this statement with reference to the story.
- Which character do you like the most in the story and why?



Vocabulary

a) Read the following words taken from the story. Give two synonyms and one antonym for each of these words. Use a dictionary, if required.

Word	Synonyms	Antonym
cautious		
disapprove		
brisk		
engaging		
humble		
eager		
resistance		
persuade		
scarce		
nobility		

b) Homophones and Confusables

You have already learnt that homophones are words that sound alike but are different in spelling and meaning. E.g. feet – feat / face – phase / sort – sought / hair – heir/

What are **confusables**?

Confusables /confusibles are words that are commonly confused with one another in meaning or usage because of slight similarities in spelling, pronunciation or meaning. e.g. moment – movement / except – expect / human – humane / discover–invent

(i) Given below is a list of common confusables. Distinguish the meaning of each pair of words by framing your own sentences.

- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| a) emigrate | - immigrate |
| b) beside | - besides |
| c) judicial | - judicious |
| d) eligible | - illegible |
| e) conscience | - conscious |
| f) industrial | - industrious |
| g) eminent | - imminent |
| h) illicit | - elicit |
| i) prescribed | - proscribed |
| j) affect | - effect |
| k) aural | - oral |
| l) born | - borne |

(ii) Fill in the blanks with suitable homophones or confusables.

wallet		hoard	
fairy		desert	
medal		night	
wait		sweet	
yoke		plain	
grown		might	
earn		quite	

c) Give the meanings of the following phrasal verbs and frame sentences using them.

cut off come upon put out
draw up pass out take off
turn away stand by bank on

d) Read the list of words formed by adding suffixes.

frequently satisfaction willingness
comfortable resemblance nobility

Form two derivatives from each of the following words by adding prefixes and suffixes.

Word	Prefix	Suffix
patient	<i>impatient</i>	<i>patiently</i>
honour		
respect		
manage		
fertile		
different		
friend		
obey		



Listening

Floods are an inevitable natural disaster which can occur in any part of the world. Floods can prove all the more disastrous in localities, where population density is high. Preparation for Disaster Management has become imperative for any city, town or village during monsoons.

The Government Department entrusted with Disaster Management makes periodic announcements about the precautions to be taken whenever floods are anticipated.

Now, you are going to listen to the cautionary instructions that are given to the general public living in flood-prone areas. Listen carefully and complete the following sentences.

- The announcement was made by the Department of_____.
- Widespread heavy rains are expected from the early hours of _____.
- The public is asked to find out the locations of_____.
- An emergency kit should contain water bottles, biscuit packets and a _____.
- A list of _____ should be displayed on the wall.
- Important documents can be secured by keeping them in a _____case.
- Damage to refrigerators can be avoided by _____.
- Mobile phones should be charged to enable the marooned to contact their friends, relatives and _____.
- _____ should be placed in the toilet bowls to prevent sewage inflow.
- Listen to the_____ and follow the instructions implicitly.



Speaking

DRAFTING A SPEECH

You learnt the art of drafting a speech in Class XI. It requires a few basic steps such as greeting the audience, introducing the topic, elaborating the main points, summarizing the views and thanking the audience.

Given below is a template for drafting a speech.

Introduction

a) Greet the audience

Formal greeting – Good Morning / Good Afternoon / Good Evening

b) Introduce yourself and the topic to the audience

I, (name) of class _____ would like to deliver a short speech on (topic).

Body of the speech

a) Elaborate the main and supporting points
Suggested value points (E.g. Global Warming)

- ❖ Definition of the title (What is global warming?)
- ❖ Importance and relevance of the topic. (Why is global warming important? What is the relevance of global warming in the present scenario?)
- ❖ Causes and consequences
- ❖ Preventive measures (planting trees / conserving fuel by using alternative energy sources)
- ❖ Solutions (change in life style and attitude / global effort of people and the government)

Conclusion

- ❖ Summarise the main points
- ❖ Appropriate winding up and thanking the audience (formal – thank you for the patient hearing / thank you for the wonderful opportunity)

Useful linkers and sequence markers

Describing similarities

- ♦ Likewise, correspondingly, equally, not only... but also, in the same way, similarly

Showing cause and effect

- ♦ Consequently, as a result, thus, therefore, for this reason

Comparing and contrasting

- ♦ Alternatively, however, conversely, on the other hand, instead, yet

Concluding

- ♦ To summarise, it can be concluded that, ultimately, as described, finally

Task 1

On the occasion of World Environment Day, you have been asked to deliver a speech during morning assembly on the importance of tree planting. **Write the speech in about 100 – 150 words.**

- ❖ Introduction
- ❖ Suggested value points

Pollution control – Medicine –
Necessary for wildlife – Cause rainfall

- ❖ Conclusion

Task 2

Prepare a speech on “The importance of a reading habit” in about 100–150 words using the hints given below together with your own ideas.

❖ Introduction

❖ Suggested value points

Knowledge enrichment – Skill development – Meaningful usage of time – Overall development

❖ Conclusion



You have learnt note-making in class XI. The following tasks are for strengthening this skill.

Steps for note-making:

1. Give a title to the passage (main idea).
2. Pick out the key points which extend the title idea (supporting ideas).
3. Pick out points, if any, which substantiate the supporting ideas (supporting details).
4. Condense the points using relevant phrases, abbreviations, acronyms, etc.
5. Pick out the concluding idea in the passage.
6. Organise the points and number them in the following format:

Title

1.
a)
b)

2.
a)
b)
3.
a)
b)

Read the passage given below and make notes.

To match the best cities across the world, the Government of India initiated ‘smart cities’ to drive economic growth and improve the quality of life of people. The agenda under smart city promises to resolve urban sustainability problems. Urban forests provide a range of important ecosystem services that are critical for the sustainability of cities. Urban forestry, which is defined more as ‘Management of Trees’ contributes to the physiological, sociological and economic well-being of the society. Mangroves, lakes, grasslands, and forests in and around our cities, act as sponges that absorb the air and noise pollution and they present themselves as our cultural and recreational hotspots. However, these spots are rapidly being reclaimed and replaced in the name of development. Presence of urban green has shown to increase the economic value of the place.

Urban forests contribute to reduce the cost of building storm water drain systems for municipalities and neutralizing urban heat island effect. Plants not only provide shade but also help in regulating the micro-climate. They help regulate energy

budgets, improve air quality, and curtail noise pollution. Trees, herbs, shrubs and grasses arrest sedimentation and prevent other pollutants from entering our water systems. This will give a chance for our urban lakes and rivers to recover and help improve aquatic ecosystems. Biodiversity also gets a boost through the urban forests

and helps create corridors connecting the forest areas. High biodiversity areas can also help to build resilient ecosystems. Availability of forests within our urban areas gives an opportunity for children to connect to the natural environment and learn about native species.



TENSES

You have learnt the use of Tenses in detail in class XI.

V - Verb

V1 - Present tense form

Tenses



V2 - Past tense form

V3 - Past participle form

Tense	Form	Example Sentence
Present Simple	S+V1+O+A	I play basketball every week.
Present Cont.	S+am/is/are+V+ing +O+A	I am playing basketball now.
Present Perfect	S+have/has+V3+O	I have just played basketball
Present Perfect Cont.	S+have/has been+V+ing+O+A	I have been playing basketball for 3 hours.
Past Simple	S+V2+O+A	I played basketball yesterday.
Past Cont.	S+was/were+V+ing+O+A	I was playing basketball the whole evening.
Past Perfect	S+had+V3+O+A	I had played basketball before he came.
Past Perfect Cont.	S+had been+V+ing+O+A	I had been playing basketball when he came.
Future Simple	S+will+V+O+A	I will play basketball tomorrow.
Future Cont.	S+will be+V+ing+O+A	I will be playing basketball tomorrow by this time.

The following tasks are for strengthening your understanding.

Task 1

Tick the correct options and complete the dialogue.

A: Hello. What *do you watch / are you watching?*

B: A programme about the Jallian Wala Bagh Massacre, which I recorded last night. *I study / I'm studying* about it this term.

A: All that *I know / I've known* about it is that hundreds of people *died / had died* in it.

B: Yes, it was much, much worse than anyone *has expected / had expected*. It *went on / has gone on* for hours. *Do you want / Have you wanted* to watch the programme with me?

A: No, thanks. I've got to do some veena practice. *I've just remembered / I just remembered* that we've got a concert tomorrow, and I *don't have / haven't had* time to practise my new piece this week.

B: OK. *I've already done / I already did* my practice, so I've got time to watch TV. See you later.

Task 2

Complete the sentences with the correct tense form of the verbs in brackets.

- (tell)** me exactly what **(happen)** last night!
- Mrs. Mageswari is my Maths teacher. She **(teach)** me for four years.

c) I **(never)** think of a career in medicine before I spoke to my Biology teacher but now I think **(seriously)** it.

d) Oh no! I **(forget)** to bring my assignment! What am I going to do? This is the second time I **(do)** this!

e) I can't remember what my teacher **(say)** yesterday about our homework. I **(not listen)** properly because Hussain **(talk)** to me at the same time.

f) Last year we **(go)** on a school trip to Kanyakumari. We **(have)** a very interesting time.

g) At the moment I **(think)** about what course to pursue next year but I **(not make)** a final decision yet.

h) I **(get)** up at 7 every morning but this morning I **(sleep)** for a long time and I **(not get)** up until 8.

Task 3

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs given in the brackets.

- Everyone _____ when the earthquake hit the small town. **(sleep)**
- Evangelene _____ her job a couple of years ago. **(quit)**
- Where _____ your last holidays? **(you spend)**
- I think Suresh _____ for Tiruvallur next morning. **(leave)**
- I was angry that I _____ such a mistake **(make)**.
- My mother was tired yesterday because she _____ well the night before **(not sleep)**.

- g) Her parents _____ in Coimbatore for two weeks from today **(be)**.
- h) Nothing much _____ when I got to the meeting **(happen)**.
- i) Scientists predict that by 2050, man _____ on Mars. **(land)**
- j) Sh! Someone _____ to our conversation! **(listen)**
- k) The plane _____ off in a few minutes. **(take)**
- l) They _____ about me when I interrupted their conversation. **(talk)**
- m) Justin and his parents _____ in an apartment right now because they can't find a cheap house. **(live)**
- n) Rajini Prem's family _____ in Chengalpet now. **(be)**.
- o) Yusuf _____ to the movies once in a while **(go)**
- p) This _____ an easy quiz so far **(be)**.
- q) Our team _____ any games last year. **(not win)**
- r) We _____ a wonderful film at the cinema last night. **(see)**
- s) Hurry up! The movie _____ **(already begin)**

Modal Auxiliaries

Read the following sentences carefully.

- (i) He can drive a car. ('can' shows ability)
- (ii) The rich should help the poor. ('should' shows moral obligation)
- (iii) It may rain today. ('may' shows possibility)

In the above sentences, 'drive', 'help' and 'rain' are Main Verbs whereas 'Can', 'Should' and 'May' are Helping Verbs that denote particular moods, expressions or conceptions of the mind. Here 'can', 'should' and 'may' express 'ability', 'moral obligation' and 'possibility' respectively. Since these auxiliaries denote moods or expressions, they are called Modal Auxiliaries.

Modal Auxiliary is a special auxiliary which is used to denote a particular mood or expression of the subject.

There are 13 Modal Auxiliaries (four of which are quasi-modals/ marginals).

will	would
shall	should
can	could
may	might
must	
ought to	dare
need	used to

The following table will help you understand better.

Modal Auxiliaries	
can	ability: I can speak English. permission: Can I go to the library? request: Can you wait a moment, please? offer: I can lend you my pen.
could	ability :(past) I could speak English. polite request: Could you wait a moment, please?
may	possibility: It may rain today. permission: May I go to the cinema?
might	possibility (less possible than may): It might rain today.
must	force, necessity: I must go to the supermarket today. recommendation: You must read the new novel by Bhagat.
shall	suggestion: Shall I carry your bag?
should	advice: You should drive carefully on the highway. obligation: You should switch off the lights when you leave the classroom.
will	wish, request, demand, order: Will you please shut the door? prediction, assumption: I think it will rain on Friday. spontaneous decision: Can somebody take me to the hospital? I will .
would	wish, request: Would you shut the door, please? habits in the past: Sometimes he would bring me some flowers.
Ought to	duty: You ought to submit your assignment on time. moral obligation: We ought to help the needy. necessity: We ought to hire some furniture for the party.
Used to	habits in the past: My grandfather used to walk for long hours when he was young.
Need to	necessity: I need to buy a packet of milk. moral obligation: We need to keep our environment clean.
Dare	boldness: I dare not go out in the dark. challenge: How dare you enter my room?

Task 1**Fill in the blanks with modal auxiliaries.**

- The candidates _____ answer five out of ten questions.
- How _____ you open my bag?
- Tajudeen _____ finish this work by Monday.
- _____ I go to school today?
- I wish you _____ tell me the truth
- Poonam _____ not catch the bus yesterday.
- People who live in glass houses _____ not throw stones.
- You _____ not go to the market as I have brought vegetables.
- _____ you have taken all this trouble?
- You _____ be joking.
- I tried to climb up the tree, but _____ not.
- Hima Das ran so fast that she _____ win the medal.
- You _____ lead a horse to water, but you _____ make it drink.
- I _____ like to have a cup of coffee.
- My grandfather _____ visit this temple when he was young.

Task 2**Complete the following sentences with modals using the clues given.**

- You _____ help the needy. (moral obligation)
- If I were you, I _____ not behave like that. (conditional sentence)
- I _____ never tell a lie. (determination)
- My uncle _____ have reached by now. (possibility)
- The patient is critical. He _____ be taken to the hospital. (compulsion)
- I _____ to play hockey when I was a student. (past habit)
- You _____ not attend my class. (order)
- He _____ come today. (remote possibility)
- You _____ follow the traffic rules. (regulation)
- He _____ play the match. (willingness)
- You _____ not waste time on it. (necessity)
- Had the doctor come in time, he _____ have saved the patient. (probability)

Reported Speech

Reported Speech is the way we represent / report the speech of other people or what we ourselves say.

Direct speech is a representation of the actual words someone said.	Indirect speech does not give the exact words uttered but focusses on the content of what someone said.
Repeating the words as exactly as spoken by the speaker.	Reporting the words spoken by the speaker.
e.g. The teacher said to the students, "I shall take you to the museum tomorrow."	e.g. The teacher informed the students that he would take them to the museum the next day.

Refer Class XI for the rules governing transformation of sentences from direct to reported speech.